

Mateusz Ciechański

Operations Director, systems delivery and process optimization

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Operations and risk director with over 10 years in fintech and banking, combining management with hands-on engineering. I launch credit institutions on new markets, build risk policies and automate lending decisions end to end. I personally design and build my own systems (decision engine, eKYC, reporting and BI, a Loan Management System, CRM) that I deploy in a company in 30-40 days. I work in pre-launch companies, in start-ups, as well as in corporations (including those supervised by a regulator).

CORE COMPETENCIES

Operational and credit risk management · AML/CFT (Anti-Money Laundering) · KYC (Know Your Customer) · CDD/EDD (Customer / Enhanced Due Diligence) · Fraud prevention · PEP and sanctions screening · BNPL (Buy Now, Pay Later) · P&L and budgeting · Scaling lending operations · Data-provider integration over API · Credit decision automation · KPI/OKR systems and executive dashboards · Regulatory compliance (FSA-supervised) · IT systems delivery · Process optimization · Automation in Python and AWS · Integrations and data flow

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Raised automated credit decisions from 7% to 90% for new customers (Creamfinance / AvaFin)
- Launched credit institutions and products on new markets (Sri Lanka, Peru, Brazil), more in preparation
- Managed operations and teams of over 100 people (KYC, risk, repayments, communication)
- Delivered around 20 IT projects in SCRUM: verification, risk scoring, automation, back office modules
- Brought the new-loan portfolio above break-even in the Spanish market
- Authored 100+ AML, KYC and compliance procedures (decision trees, anti-fraud)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Operations and Risk Director

CreamHub SIA (Latvia) | Latvia | 2024 - present

Risk management and launch of credit and phone financing products on new markets (Sri Lanka, Peru), plus preparing further markets for expansion.

- Launched credit and phone financing products in Sri Lanka and Peru
- Prepared further markets for expansion (Malaysia, Albania, UAE)
- End to end risk management and credit policy
- Built an eKYC tool: identity assessment, text extraction (OCR), face library, fraud detection
- Selected data providers, built API integrations and automated decisions

Analytics Business Manager

Biuro Informacji Kredytowej S.A. (BIK) | Warsaw, Poland | 2023 - 2023

Development of the BIK analytics product and commercialization of analytics. Product support for the BNPL and Fintech area.

- Strategy, needs analysis, pricing, implementation and project management
- Onboarding of data sources and data consumers, closing RnD projects
- Framework for a new advisory product
- Optimization of the reporting product for BNPL
- Advisory for Fintech on regulation and Polish FSA supervision

Head of Verification

Creamfinance Holding (AvaFin) | Warsaw, Poland | 2020 - 2023

Credit institution supervised by the Polish FSA. Oversight of the product lifecycle (KYC, risk, repayments, communication) and management of operational teams.

- Rebuilt the OKR, KPI and dashboard system from scratch
- Business reporting for the board and investors
- Grew Surplus on new loans above break even in Spain
- Managed operational teams across KYC, risk, repayments and communication

Operations Director (Product Owner)

Akulaku China (Silvrr+) | China | 2021 - 2022

E-commerce and BNPL platform. End to end implementation and risk management.

- Launched and ran the BNPL service (strategy, recruitment, risk policy, vendors, anti-fraud)
- Prepared store and BNPL launch in Poland and Italy (budget, vendors, translations, legal, UAT)

COO / CRO, Co-founder

Credjet Brazil (Funeda) | Brazil | 2018 - 2020

Running companies in Brazil and Poland across the full operations and risk scope.

- Launched credit institutions, a healthy portfolio and a recognizable brand, met partner bank standards
- Secured over 1M PLN in funding and implemented two major IT systems: CRM and BRM (Business Rule Management)
- Set up and equipped 3 offices (2 in Poland, 1 in Brazil)
- Recruited and managed teams with diverse competencies
- Delivered a dozen large IT projects (lifecycle, back office, migrations, BI in Power BI, risk rules), 10+ vendors over API

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Board Advisor / Product Owner

Fintredo (Intredo) | Poland | 2016 - 2018

Launched a lending company from scratch, managed risk and operations and optimized costs across the Intredo group.

OWN PROJECTS

- **Furia**: Credit decision engine with a visual policy editor and reporting (Python, React, PostgreSQL)
- **FacesAces**: Production eKYC: OCR, face matching and identity deduplication (AWS Lambda, Rekognition, Textract, DynamoDB)
- **BiEyeCyclops.com**: Whole Management System, end to end management of a lending institution (AWS Lambda, RDS, Terraform, React)
- **arbedo**: Time and attendance system for the NL, DE and PL markets (React, Python, PostgreSQL)

EDUCATION

- MSc, Banking, University of Łódź
- Agile PM Certificate (APMG, Practitioner level)

LANGUAGES

English (C1), Italian (B1), German (B1)

INTERESTS

Automotive, Motorhomes, Watches, Technology, Geopolitics and business